

# Brandon Waldon

## Education

- 2017–present **PhD Candidate, Linguistics, Stanford University, Stanford, CA.**  
Dissertation title: *Probabilistic language understanding and formal linguistic theory*  
Committee: Cleo Condoravdi and Judith Degen (co-chairs); Beth Levin; Guillermo Del Pinal
- 2015 **Bachelor of Arts, Linguistics, University of Chicago, Chicago, IL.**

## Fellowships & Awards

- 2022–present **Seed Research Grant, Stanford Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (HAI).**  
Title: *Towards Clear, Transparent, and Scalable Computational Contract Technology*  
(Co-authored with Megan Ma, Stanford Law School; Lead PI: Judith Degen)
- 2023 **Student Travel Grant, Cognitive Science Society.**
- 2019–2022 **Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation.**
- 2019 **Community Impact Award, Stanford Alumni Association.**
- 2018 **Summer Language Intensive Grant, Stanford School of Humanities & Sciences.**
- 2016–2017 **Fulbright Student Research Grant, U.S. Department of State.**  
Host institution: Das Zentrum für Allgemeine Sprachwissenschaft (ZAS), Berlin, Germany.

## Publications

(Note: \* denotes multiple first authors.)

### In Preparation

Brandon Waldon. The metalinguistic character of multi-agent legal decision-making: experimental evidence.

Dean Manko, Brandon Waldon, Katherine Hilton, and Judith Degen. Look who's talking: Examining the role of racialized beliefs in subjective evaluations of overlapping speech.

Judith Degen\* and Brandon Waldon\* *et al.* Evaluating computational models of referring expression production on cross-linguistic interactive experimental data.

### Journal Articles

- 2019 Stephanie Solt and Brandon Waldon. Numerals under negation: Empirical findings. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics*.
- 2019 Masoud Jasbi, Brandon Waldon, and Judith Degen. Linking hypothesis and number of response options modulate inferred scalar implicature rate. *Frontiers in Psychology*.
- 2019 Guillermo Del Pinal\* and Brandon Waldon\*. Modals under epistemic tension. *Natural Language Semantics*.

### Refereed Conference Proceedings and Book Chapters

- to appear Dhara Yu, Brandon Waldon, and Judith Degen. Cross-linguistic variability in adjective-noun order may be the result of pragmatic pressures on referential communication. In *Proceedings of the 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

- to appear Brandon Waldon, Cleo Condoravdi, Beth Levin, and Judith Degen. On the context dependence of artifact noun interpretation. In *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 27*.
- to appear Brandon Waldon, Madigan Brodsky, Megan Ma, and Judith Degen. Predicting consensus in legal document interpretation. In *Proceedings of the 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- to appear Megan Ma, Brandon Waldon, and Julian Nyarko. Conceptual questions in developing expert-annotated data. In *Proceedings of the Nineteenth International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Law*.
- 2022 Brandon Waldon. A novel probabilistic approach to linguistic imprecision. In Nicole Gotzner and Uli Sauerland, editors, *Measurements, Numerals and Scales: Essays in Honour of Stephanie Solt*.
- 2022 Brandon Waldon. Epistemic must and might: evidence that argumentation is semantically encoded. In *Proceedings of the Fifty-sixth Annual Meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society*.
- 2022 Leyla Kursat, Brandon Waldon, Rabia Ergin, and Judith Degen. Evaluating models of referring expression production on an emerging sign language. In *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- 2021 Brandon Waldon and Judith Degen. Modeling cross-linguistic production of referring expressions. *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics*.
- 2020 Brandon Waldon and Judith Degen. Symmetric alternatives and semantic uncertainty modulate scalar inference. In *Proceedings of the 42nd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.
- 2020 Brandon Waldon and Judith Degen. Modeling Behavior in Truth Value Judgment Task Experiments. In *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics*.
- 2020 Brandon Waldon. Linguistic interpretation as inference under argument system uncertainty: the case of epistemic must. In *Proceedings of the Probability and Meaning Conference (PaM 2020)*.
- 2020 Austin Van Loon\*, Sheridan Stewart\*, Brandon Waldon\*, Shrinidhi K Lakshmikanth, Ishan Shah, Sharath Chandra Guntuku, Garrick Sherman, James Zou, and Johannes Eichstaedt. Explaining the 'Trump Gap' in Social Distancing Using COVID Discourse. In *Proceedings of the 1st Workshop on NLP for COVID-19 (Part 2) at EMNLP 2020*.
- 2017 Hadil Karawani\* and Brandon Waldon\*. May or might? strength, duality, and social meaning. In *Proceedings of Amsterdam Colloquium 21*.

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## Volumes Edited

- 2019 Vera Gribanova, Sabrina Grimberg, Erika Petersen O'Farrill, Eva Portelance, and Brandon Waldon, editors. *Proceedings of the 27th Meeting of Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics*. Michigan Slavic Press.

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## Selected Recent Presentations

- 2022 Brandon Waldon\*, Judith Degen\*, Leyla Kursat, Adolfo Hermosillo, Anthony Velasquez, and Rabia Ergin. The color/size asymmetry in redundant modification replicates cross-linguistically. Lightning talk presented at *Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM) 2*, Philadelphia, PA.

- 2022 Brandon Waldon, Cleo Condoravdi, Beth Levin, and Judith Degen. Modeling the context dependence of artifact noun interpretation. Talk presented at the *9th Experimental Pragmatics Conference (XPrag)*, Pavia, Italy.
- 2022 Brandon Waldon, Cleo Condoravdi, Beth Levin, and Judith Degen. Context dependence of artifact noun interpretation. Poster presented at *Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)*, Prague, Czechia.
- 2022 Brandon Waldon. Modeling the context dependence of artifact noun interpretation. Invited colloquium talk at Georgia Institute of Technology.
- 2022 Stefan Pophristic, Brandon Waldon, and Judith Degen. Pragmatic use of morphological information in Serbo-Croatian redundant referring expression production. Poster presented by S. Pophristic at the *9th Experimental Pragmatics Conference (XPrag)*, Pavia, Italy.
- 2022 Judith Degen\*, Brandon Waldon\*, Adolfo Hermsillo, Anthony Velasquez, and Zeinab Kachakeche. Spanish exhibits a color/size asymmetry and scene variation effects in redundant modification. (Just like English). Talk presented at the *9th Experimental Pragmatics Conference (XPrag)*, Pavia, Italy.
- 2021 Jess Mankewitz\*, Veronica Boyce\*, Brandon Waldon, Georgia Loukatou, Dhara Yu, Jesse Mu, Noah D Goodman, and Michael C Frank. Multi-party referential communication in complex strategic games. Talk presented by J. Mankewitz online at the *Meaning in Context Workshop at the 35th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2021)*.

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## Academic & Departmental Service

- Reviewing **Journals:** Semantics & Pragmatics (2020); Mind & Language (2021); Discourse Processes (2022); Journal of Memory & Language (2022). **Conferences:** California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP, 2019); CogSci (2021 & 2022).
- Committee service **Conference organizing:** Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics (FASL, 2018); Stanford Semantics Fest (SemFest, 2019); West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL, 2022). **Admissions and hiring:** Stanford Center for Study of Language and Information (CSLI) Summer Internship Program (2021); IDEAL Provostial Fellowship Program (Department of Linguistics nominating committee, 2021).
- Other service Diversity & Inclusion Committee Member, Stanford Department of Linguistics (2020-2021); Student Coordinator, Stanford Words With Friends reading group (2019-2021); Linguistics Representative, Stanford Wellness Information Network for Graduate Students (WINGS, 2018-2021); Graduate Student Coordinator, Stanford Cognition & Language Workshop (2018-2021); Graduate Student Representative to the Department of Linguistics (2019-2020); Social Committee Member, Stanford Department of Linguistics (2017-2018).

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## Teaching Assistantship Experience

- Fall 2022 **LINGUIST 116A: Introduction to Word-Formation**, Stanford, (grading only).
- Winter 2022 **LINGUIST 30N: Linguistic Meaning and the Law**, Stanford, (grading only).
- Spring 2021 **LINGUIST 130B: Introduction to Lexical Semantics**, Stanford.
- Winter 2021 **LINGUIST 116A: Introduction to Word-Formation**, Stanford, (grading only).
- Fall 2019 **PSYCH 140: Introduction to Psycholinguistics**, Stanford.
- 2018–2019 **Lab TA**, Stanford Linguistics.
- Fall 2018 **PSYCH 140: Introduction to Psycholinguistics**, Stanford, (grading only).

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## Selected Tutorials and Workshops

- Fall 2021 **Bayesian Power Analysis in R**, Stanford ALPS Lab.  
Spring 2019 **Introduction to Unix Systems**, Stanford Linguistics.  
Spring 2019 **Introduction to Web-Based Experimentation**, Stanford Linguistics.  
Spring 2019 **Introduction to Remote Computing**, Stanford Linguistics.

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## Invited Guest Lectures

- Winter 2022 **LINGUIST 30N: Linguistic Meaning and the Law**, Stanford University.  
Fall 2021 **LINGUIST 196: Undergraduate Research Seminar**, Stanford University.  
Winter 2021 **LINGUIST 30N: Linguistic Meaning and the Law**, Stanford University.  
Winter 2020 **LINGUIST 30N: Linguistic Meaning and the Law**, Stanford University.

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## Mentorship Experience

- Summer 2022 **Angelique Charles-Davis and Manh Dao**, Stanford BA '24, VPUE Summer Internship Program.  
2020-2021 **Dean Manko**, Stanford BA '20 MS '22, Mentor for undergraduate honors and master's thesis projects and through the VPUE Summer Internship Program (Summer 2020).  
Fall 2021 **Stefan Pophristic**, ALPS Lab Manager, Directed study through ALPS Lab.  
Fall 2021 **Leyla Kursat**, Stanford MS '22, Directed study through ALPS Lab.  
Spring 2021 **Qi Han**, Stanford BA '22, ALPS Lab Internship Program.  
Spring 2021 **Andrew Yang**, Stanford BS '22, ALPS Lab Internship Program.  
Summer 2019 **Leyla Kursat**, Stanford MS '22, Directed study through ALPS Lab.  
Summer 2019 **Francesca Vera**, Stanford BS/MS '20, VPUE Summer Internship Program.

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## Skills

- Natural languages English (native), German (advanced/C2 proficiency), Arabic (intermediate/B1 proficiency), French (beginner/A2 proficiency), Spanish (fieldwork), Vietnamese (fieldwork)  
Programming R, Python,  $\LaTeX$ , PyTorch, Unix shell, Javascript, WebPPL, NodeJS, PHP, HTML

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## References

**Cleo Condoravdi**, *Professor of Linguistics*, Stanford University.  
cleoc@stanford.edu

**Judith Degen**, *Assistant Professor of Linguistics*, Stanford University.  
jdegen@stanford.edu

**Beth Levin**, *William H. Bonsall Professor in the Humanities*, Stanford University.  
bclevin@stanford.edu